

Law 12 – Fouls and Misconduct (p. 123)

4. Disciplinary action

Amended text

Delaying the restart of play

Referees must caution players who excessively delay the restart of play, including as outlined in Laws 3, 15 and 16 and their protocols, or by:

- ~~appearing to take a throw-in but suddenly leaving it to a team-mate to take~~
- ~~delaying leaving the field of play when being substituted~~
- ~~excessively delaying a restart~~
- kicking or carrying the ball away, or provoking a confrontation by deliberately touching the ball after the referee has stopped play
- taking a free kick from the wrong position to force a retake

Explanation

As the referee now has the power to punish a team for delaying a throw-in by awarding it to the opposing team and for delaying a goal kick by awarding a corner kick to the opposing team, this is considered sufficient punishment unless the action of the player(s) causing the delay is extreme.

Law 12 – Fouls and Misconduct (p. 124)

4. Disciplinary action

Additional text

Denying a goal or an obvious goal-scoring opportunity (DOGSO)

(...)

The following must be considered:

- distance between the offence and the goal
- general direction of the play
- likelihood of keeping or gaining control of the ball
- location and number of defenders and attackers

Explanation

The location and number of attackers are included in the DOGSO considerations, as this can also help determine whether an obvious goal-scoring opportunity exists.

Law 14 – The Penalty Kick (p. 136, 138)

2. Offences and sanctions

Amended text

If, before the ball is in play, one of the following occurs:

- the kicker accidentally kicks the ball with both feet simultaneously or the ball touches their non-kicking foot or leg immediately after the kick:
 - if the ball enters the goal from the kick, the kick is retaken
 - if the ball does not enter the goal from the kick, an indirect free kick is awarded
- (...)
- ~~both the goalkeeper and the kicker commit an offence at the same time, the kicker is cautioned and play restarts with an indirect free kick to the defending team~~

If, after the penalty kick has been taken:

- the kicker deliberately touches the ball again before it has touched another player:
 - an indirect free kick (or direct free kick for a handball offence) is awarded

Explanation

Inclusion of text to confirm the clarification announced in circular no. 31 concerning an accidental double touch by the penalty taker. This change also required the removal of the reference to the kicker being automatically cautioned if they offend at the same time as the goalkeeper.

Law 15 – The Throw-in (p. 141, 142)

Additional text

A throw-in is awarded to the opponents of the player who last touched the ball when the whole of the ball passes over the touchline, on the ground or in the air, or when the referee penalises a player for delaying the taking of a throw-in for their team.
(...)

2. Offences and sanctions

Additional text

If a player is unfairly delaying the taking of a throw-in for their team, the referee will whistle and signal the start of a five-second countdown. The referee will visually count down the five seconds with a raised hand, and if the throw-in has not been taken by the end of the five seconds, it is awarded to the opposing team. The offending player is cautioned only if they excessively delay the restart after the throw-in has been awarded to the opposing team.*

If, after the ball is in play, (...)

*See 'Throw-in and goal-kick countdown protocol' under 'Notes and modifications'.

Explanation

Text introduced to avoid delays at throw-ins. If a team is deliberately delaying their throw-in, the referee will whistle, signal for the throw-in to be taken and then start a visual five-second countdown. If the throw-in has not been taken by the end of the countdown, it is awarded to the opposing team.

Law 16 – The Goal Kick (p. 145, 146)

2. Offences and sanctions

Additional text

If a player is unfairly delaying the taking of a goal kick for their team, the referee will whistle and signal the start of a five-second countdown. The referee will visually count down the five seconds with a raised hand, and if the goal kick has not been taken by the end of the five seconds, a corner kick is awarded to the opposing team. The offending player is cautioned only if they excessively delay the restart after the corner kick has been awarded to the opposing team.*

If, after the ball is in play, (...)

*See ‘Throw-in and goal-kick countdown protocol’ under ‘Notes and modifications’.

Explanation

Text introduced to avoid delays at goal kicks. If a team is deliberately delaying their goal kick, the referee will whistle, signal for the goal kick to be taken and then start a visual five-second countdown. If the goal kick has not been taken by the end of the countdown, a corner kick is awarded to the opposing team.

Law 17 – The Corner Kick (p. 149)

Additional text

A corner kick is awarded when:

- the whole of the ball passes over the goal line, on the ground or in the air, having last touched a player of the defending team, and a goal is not scored (see also Laws 8, 12, 13, 15 and 16):
- the referee penalises:
 - the goalkeeper for controlling the ball with their hand(s)/arm(s) for more than eight seconds
 - a player for delaying the taking of a goal kick for their team

Explanation

A corner kick may be awarded when the referee penalises a goalkeeper for holding the ball for too long or a team for delaying their goal kick.

Video assistant referee (VAR) protocol (p. 153, 154, 155)

1. Principles

Amended text

The use of VARs in football matches is based on a number of principles, all of which must apply in every match using VARs (except for incorrectly awarded corner kicks – see point e. under ‘2. Reviewable decisions/incidents’).

1. A video assistant referee (VAR) is a match official, with independent access to match footage, who may assist the referee only in the event of a ‘clear and obvious error’ or ‘serious missed incident’ in relation to:
 - a. **Goal/no goal**
 - b. **Penalty/no penalty**
 - c. **Direct-red Red card** (not including a clearly incorrect second caution)
 - d. **Mistaken identity** (when the referee cautions or sends off the wrong player of the offending team)

(...)

2. Reviewable match-changing decisions/incidents

Amended text

The referee may receive assistance from the VAR only in relation to ~~four~~ five categories of ~~match-changing~~ decisions/incidents.

(...)

The categories of decision/incident which may be reviewed in the event of a potential ‘clear and obvious error’ or ‘serious missed incident’ are:

(...)

- c. **Direct-red Red cards** (~~not second yellow card/caution~~)
 - DOGSO (especially position of offence and positions of other players)
 - serious foul play (or reckless challenge)
 - violent conduct, biting or spitting at another person
 - using offensive, insulting or abusive action(s)
 - clearly incorrect second caution

d. Mistaken identity (red or yellow card)

If the referee penalises an offence but has clearly misidentified the player who committed that offence ~~and then gives the wrong player from the offending (penalised) team a yellow or red card~~, only the identity of the offender can be reviewed, ~~the actual offence itself cannot be reviewed unless it relates to a goal, penalty incident or direct red card.~~

e. Clearly incorrectly awarded corner kick if the decision can be changed immediately and without delaying the restart (competition option)

Explanation

Reviewable decisions/incidents now include two infrequent but potentially match-changing errors:

- Red card resulting from a clearly incorrect second yellow card
- Mistaken identity when the referee shows a yellow or red card but has clearly penalised the wrong player of either team for the offence in question; the offence itself cannot be reviewed except in the context of mistaken identity

In addition, competitions have the option to review a clearly incorrectly awarded corner kick (including when the ball has gone out of play over the touchline) provided that this can be done immediately and without delaying the restart. If the corner kick is taken quickly, then the decision cannot be changed.

The 'TV signal' is required if the decision is changed after receiving information from the VAR.



Editorial changes

Law 5 – The Referee (p. 74)

2. Decisions of the referee

Amended text

(...)

Except as outlined in Law ~~12.3~~ 12.4 and the VAR protocol, a disciplinary sanction may only be issued (...)

Law 5 – The Referee (p. 77)

4. Video assistant referee (VAR)

Amended text

The use of video assistant referees (VARs) is only permitted where (...) all ~~Implementation Assistance and Approval Programme (IAAP) the~~ implementation requirements as set out in ~~FIFA's IAAP documents~~ the VAR Handbook, and (...)

Law 5 – The Referee (p. 78, 80)

6. Referee signals

Additional signal

New referee throw-in signal added.



Throw-in

Amended signal

Image for penalty kick changed to referee blowing the whistle.



Penalty kick |

Amended signal

Image for corner kick changed to referee not blowing the whistle.



Corner kick |

Law 12 – Fouls and Misconduct (p. 121)

4. Disciplinary action

Additional text

Cautionable offences

A player is cautioned if guilty of:

- delaying the restart of play (as outlined below in ‘Delaying the restart of play’)
 - (...)
-

Law 14 – The Penalty Kick (p. 137)

2. Offences and sanctions

Additional text

If, before the ball is in play, one of the following occurs:

(...)

- the player taking the penalty kick or a team-mate offends:
 - if the ball enters the goal from the kick, the kick is retaken
 - if the ball does not enter the goal from the kick, the referee stops play and restarts with an indirect free kick

(...)

- the goalkeeper offends:
 - if the ball enters the goal from the kick, a goal is awarded

(...)

- a team-mate of the goalkeeper offends:
 - if the ball enters the goal from the kick, a goal is awarded
 - if the ball does not enter the goal from the kick, the kick is retaken

Law 14 – The Penalty Kick (p. 138, 139)

3. Summary table

Amended text

Outcome of the penalty kick

	Goal <u>scored from the kick</u>	No goal <u>scored from the kick</u>
Encroachment <u>only</u> by attacking player(s)	Impact: penalty is retaken No impact: goal	Impact: indirect free kick No impact: no retake
Encroachment <u>only</u> by defending player(s)	Impact: goal No impact: goal	Impact: penalty is retaken No impact: no retake

Encroachment by defending and attacking player(s)	Impact <u>by both defending and attacking player(s)</u> : penalty is retaken <u>Impact by defending player(s) only: goal</u> <u>Impact by attacking player(s) only: penalty is retaken</u> No impact: goal	Impact <u>by both defending and attacking player(s)</u> : penalty is retaken <u>Impact by defending player(s) only: penalty is retaken</u> <u>Impact by attacking player(s) only: no retake</u> No impact: no retake
Offence <u>only</u> by goalkeeper	Goal	Not saved: penalty is not retaken (unless kicker is clearly impacted) Saved: penalty is retaken and warning for goalkeeper; caution for any further offence(s)
Goalkeeper and kicker offend at the same time	Indirect free kick and caution for kicker <u>Penalty is retaken unless kicker commits one of the offences below</u>	Indirect free kick and caution for kicker <u>Penalty is retaken unless kicker commits one of the offences below</u>
<u>Double touch by kicker</u>	<u>Accidental: penalty is retaken</u> <u>Deliberate: indirect free kick</u>	<u>Accidental: indirect free kick; penalty is retaken if goalkeeper also offends</u> <u>Deliberate: indirect free kick</u>
Ball kicked backwards	Indirect free kick	Indirect free kick
'Illegal' feinting	Indirect free kick and caution for kicker	Indirect free kick and caution for kicker
Wrong kicker	Indirect free kick and caution for wrong kicker	Indirect free kick and caution for wrong kicker
<u>Unsporting behaviour by kicker</u>	<u>Indirect free kick and caution for kicker</u>	<u>Indirect free kick and caution for kicker</u>

Video assistant referee (VAR) protocol (p. 153)

Amended text

The use of video assistant referees (VARs) is only permitted where (...) all the ~~Implementation Assistance and Approval Programme (IAAP) implementation~~ requirements as set out in ~~FIFA's IAAP documents~~ the VAR Handbook, and (...)

Glossary – Football terms (p. 196, 197, 202)

Amended and Additional text

Advantage

The referee allows play to continue when an offence has occurred, or a restart has been incorrectly taken and the ball is in play, if this benefits the ~~non-offending~~ opposing team

Careless

Any action (usually a tackle or challenge) by a player which shows a lack of care or attention for the opponent

~~Kicks from the penalty mark~~

See 'Penalties (penalty shoot-out)'

Restart position

A player's position at a restart is determined by the position of their feet or any part of their body which is touching the ground, except as outlined in Law 11 – Offside; if the player is airborne, their position is determined by the projected position of their feet if they were touching the ground

Semi-automated offside technology (SAOT)

Technology which immediately sends information in relation to offside positions to the video assistant referee (VAR) and, in an advanced version, also directly to the assistant referees





Glossary

The Glossary contains words/phrases which need clarification or explanation beyond the detail in the Laws and/or which are not always easily translated into other languages.

Football bodies

The IFAB – The International Football Association Board

Body composed of the four British FAs and FIFA which is responsible for the Laws of the Game worldwide. In principle, changes to the Laws may only be approved at the Annual General Meeting usually held in February or March

FIFA – Fédération Internationale de Football Association

The governing body responsible for football throughout the world

Confederation

Body responsible for football in a continent. The six confederations are AFC (Asia), CAF (Africa), Concacaf (North, Central America and Caribbean), CONMEBOL (South America), OFC (Oceania) and UEFA (Europe)

National football association

Body responsible for football in a country

Football terms

A

Abandon

To end/terminate a match before the scheduled finish

Additional time

Time allowed at the end of each half for time 'lost' because of substitutions, injuries, disciplinary action, goal celebrations etc.

Advantage

The referee allows play to continue when an offence has occurred, or a restart has been incorrectly taken and the ball is in play, if this benefits the opposing team

Assessment of injured player

Quick examination of an injury, usually by a medical person, to see if the player requires treatment

Away goals rule

Method of deciding a match/tie when both teams have scored the same number of goals; goals scored away from home count double

B

Brutality

An act which is savage, ruthless or deliberately violent

C

Careless

Any action (usually a tackle or challenge) by a player which shows a lack of care or attention for the opponent

Caution

Disciplinary sanction which results in a report to a disciplinary authority; indicated by showing a yellow card; two cautions in a match result in a player or team official being sent off

Challenge

An action when a player competes/contests with an opponent for the ball

Charge (an opponent)

Physical challenge against an opponent, usually using the shoulder and upper arm (which is kept close to the body)

Concussion substitution

A competition option that allows each team to make an extra substitution (and grants them an extra substitution opportunity, where applicable) if one of their players suffers an actual or suspected concussion

See 'Additional permanent concussion substitutions protocol'

'Cooling' break

In the interests of player welfare and safety, competition rules may allow, in certain weather conditions (high humidity and temperatures), 'cooling' breaks (usually ninety seconds to three minutes) to allow the body's temperature to fall; these are different from 'drinks' breaks

D

Deceive

Act to mislead/trick the referee into giving an incorrect decision/disciplinary sanction which benefits the deceiver and/or their team

Deliberate

An action which the player intended/meant to make; it is not a 'reflex' or unintended reaction

Direct free kick

A free kick from which a goal can be scored by kicking the ball directly into the opponents' goal without having to touch another player

Discretion

Judgment used by a referee or other match official when making a decision

Dissent

Public protest or disagreement (verbal and/or physical) with a match official's decision; punishable by a caution (yellow card)

Distract

Disturb, confuse or draw attention (usually unfairly)

'Drinks' break

Competition rules may allow 'drinks' breaks (of no more than one minute) for players to rehydrate; these are different from 'cooling' breaks

Dropped ball

The restart when play has been stopped by the referee without an offence having been committed, e.g. due to injury, a defective ball etc. (see Law 8)

E

Electronic performance and tracking system (EPTS)

System which records and analyses data about the physical and physiological performance of a player

Endanger the safety of an opponent

Put an opponent at danger or risk (of injury)

Excessive force

Using more force/energy than is necessary

Extra time

A method of trying to decide the outcome of a match involving two equal additional periods of play not exceeding 15 minutes each

F

Feinting

An action which attempts to confuse an opponent. The Laws define permitted and 'illegal' feinting

Field of play (pitch)

The playing area confined by the touchlines and goal lines and goal nets where used

G

Goal line technology (GLT)

Electronic system which immediately informs the referee when a goal has been scored i.e. the ball has wholly passed over the goal line in the goal (see Law 1 for details)

H

Holding offence

A holding offence occurs only when a player's contact with an opponent's body or equipment impedes the opponent's movement

Hybrid system

A combination of artificial and natural materials to create a playing surface which requires sunlight, water, air circulation and mowing

I

Impede

To delay, block or prevent an opponent's action or movement

Indirect free kick

A free kick from which a goal can only be scored if another player (of any team) touches the ball after it has been kicked

Intercept

To prevent a ball reaching its intended destination

K

Kick

The ball is kicked when a player makes contact with it with the foot and/or the ankle

N

Negligible

Insignificant, minimal